

Grinding: something we do that in itself doesn't really advance the story or campaign, but something we need to do in order to advance in the story or unlock higher tier abilities.

Grinding is something few people can find to be the most fun part of the game, while others can find it extremely annoying, frustrating, and unnecessary, among other things. However, this depends. There are factors like the game you're playing and your own personal preferences, but at the end of the day, why DO we grind? What is it about grinding that makes us feel

accomplished? Or for that matter, do we actually feel accomplished at all? Let's find out.

How'd this grinding thing come about and what is it?

Well, let's do a short backstory first. The concept of 'grinding' first became popular when JRPGs hit the mainstream. Most famously, the Final Fantasy series. Grinding on weaker mobs or foes so that you had better stats and abilities, approaching the next level or boss meant that your next boss fight or level would be that much easier. Most of us would definitely prefer having

better stats going into a tough level or boss fight.

Now mechanically speaking, that's it. No seriously, that's it. That's all there is to grinding. But that can't possibly be the only reason we do it, right? Think about it, doing the same thing over and over and over again, the same fight sequence, the same enemy, the same map, the same background (and background music), all for a small amount of exp points as you slowly and gradually approach the next level, GAH! You get the idea, it can get awfully boring (and frustrating in some cases). Now from a game designer's perspective – who'd want

GRINDING IN VIDEOGAMES: WHY DO WE DO IT?

Having played a number of open world video games, we try to answer, to grind or not to grind.

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COMPLETED...

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